

Shambhala Bangkok

Admin Walkthrough Guide

Website Administration Manual

Version 1.0 — March 2026

1. Introduction

Welcome to the Shambhala Bangkok website administration guide. This document walks you through every aspect of managing the site, from creating events to publishing blog posts and monitoring site health.

Who is this guide for?

- Community coordinators who manage events
- Content editors who write blog posts
- Site administrators who oversee the website

What you'll need:

- A modern web browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge)
 - Your CMS login credentials (provided by the site administrator)
 - Access to the GitHub repository (for advanced operations)
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2. Accessing the Admin Area

2.1 Admin Dashboard

The internal admin dashboard provides a quick overview of your content:

1. Open your browser
2. Navigate to `https://shambhala-bangkok.org/admin-dashboard`
3. You'll see:
 - **Stats tiles** — total events, blog posts, and pages
 - **Quick actions** — links to create new content or open the CMS
 - **Upcoming events** — next scheduled events
 - **Recent posts** — latest blog articles

Note: The admin dashboard is informational. To create or edit content, use the Decap CMS.

2.2 Decap CMS (Content Editor)

The visual content editor is where you create and manage all content:

1. Navigate to `https://shambhala-bangkok.org/admin/`
2. Click **Login with GitHub** (or your configured auth provider)
3. Authorize the application if prompted
4. You'll see the **Content Manager** with collections:
 - **Events** — meditation sessions, workshops, retreats
 - **Blog** — articles, announcements, reflections
 - **Pages** — static page content

3. Managing Events

3.1 Creating a New Event

1. In Decap CMS, click **Events** in the sidebar
2. Click the **New Event** button
3. Fill in the required fields:

Field	Required	Description
Title	Yes	Event name (e.g., "Wednesday Evening Meditation")
Slug	Yes	URL path — auto-generated from title
Start Date	Yes	Event start with time (Bangkok timezone GMT+7)
End Date	Yes	Event end with time
Summary	Yes	1-2 sentences for event cards and search results
Body	Yes	Full description in Markdown
Modality	Yes	<code>in-person</code> , <code>online</code> , or <code>hybrid</code>
Pricing	Yes	<code>free</code> , <code>donation</code> , or <code>paid</code>
Status	Yes	<code>upcoming</code> , <code>cancelled</code> , or <code>past</code>

Optional fields:

Field	Description
Tags	Categories: meditation, workshop, retreat, online, etc.
Featured Image	Upload or provide URL for the event banner
Registration URL	External link (Meetup, Google Form)
Max Participants	Capacity limit (leave empty for unlimited)
Facilitator Name	Who leads the session
Facilitator Bio	Short bio of the facilitator
Location Override	If different from default (Young Place Building)
Price Amount	Numeric amount for paid events
Price Currency	THB, USD, EUR

4. Preview your content in the right panel

5. Click **Publish** to make it live

Important: After publishing, the site rebuilds automatically. Changes appear within 1-2 minutes.

3.2 Event Lifecycle

Follow this workflow for every event:

```
CREATE event (status: upcoming)
↓
EVENT HAPPENS
↓
UPDATE status to "past"
↓
(Optional) Add recap or photos to the body
```

Cancelling an event:

1. Open the event
2. Change Status to `cancelled`
3. Add a notice at the top of the body: `> **This event has been cancelled.**`
4. Publish

3.3 Recurring Events

For weekly sessions (e.g., Wednesday Meditation):

1. Create one event per session date
2. Use a consistent naming convention: `Wednesday Evening Meditation – March 25`
3. Keep the same slug prefix: `wednesday-evening-meditation-2026-03-25`
4. Copy the previous week's event and update the date

Tip: Create events at least 2 weeks in advance so they appear in the weekly digest.

3.4 Event Calendar Feed

The site automatically generates an ICS calendar feed at:

- **All events:** `/api/calendar/feed.ics`
- **Single event:** `/api/events/[slug]/ics`

Users can subscribe to the feed in Google Calendar, Apple Calendar, or Outlook. No action needed from you — this is fully automatic.

4. Managing Blog Posts

4.1 Creating a New Post

1. In Decap CMS, click **Blog** in the sidebar
2. Click **New Blog Post**
3. Fill in the fields:

Field	Required	Description
Title	Yes	Article headline
Slug	Yes	URL path (auto-generated)
Date	Yes	Publication date
Author	Yes	Author name
Excerpt	Yes	2-3 sentence summary for cards
Body	Yes	Full article in Markdown
Tags	No	Categories for organization
Featured Image	No	Header image

4. Click **Publish**

4.2 Writing Best Practices

- **Keep paragraphs short** — 2-3 sentences for easy scanning
- **Use headings** (`## Heading`) to break up long articles
- **Target 300-800 words** per post
- **Include a call to action** — link to an upcoming event or community channel
- **Add images** to increase engagement
- **Use internal links** when referencing events or other pages

4.3 Markdown Quick Reference

```
## Heading 2
### Heading 3

**Bold text** and italic text

[Link text](https://example.com)

![Image description](image-url.jpg)

- Bullet point
- Another point

1. Numbered list
2. Second item

> Blockquote – great for callouts or quotes
```

4.4 Content Calendar

Suggested publishing schedule:

Day	Content Type	Example
Monday	Weekly preview	"This Week at Shambhala Bangkok"
Wednesday	Post-session update	Recap + reflection
Friday	Weekend preview	Upcoming workshop details
1st of month	Monthly newsletter	Events digest + community news

5. Managing Images

5.1 Image Guidelines

Aspect	Recommendation
Format	WebP or JPEG (photos), PNG (graphics)
Max width	1200px
Max file size	200KB
Naming	Descriptive: <code>wednesday-meditation-group.jpg</code>
Alt text	Always describe the image content

5.2 Uploading Images

1. In the CMS editor, click the **+** button or image icon
2. Choose **Upload** to select from your computer
3. Add descriptive **alt text** (required for accessibility)
4. The image is stored in the Git repository

Tip: Compress images before uploading using squoosh.app or tinypng.com.

6. Newsletter Management

6.1 How Signups Work

1. Visitors enter their email in the newsletter form (footer or dedicated section)
2. The form includes a hidden **honeypot field** to block bots
3. A **rate limiter** prevents abuse (max 5 signups/minute per IP)
4. Valid emails are forwarded to **Brevo** (your email service)

6.2 Managing Subscribers in Brevo

1. Log in to app.brevo.com
2. Go to **Contacts** to see all subscribers
3. Create **segments** for targeted campaigns
4. Send newsletters using Brevo's email editor

6.3 Unsubscribe Handling

Brevo automatically adds an unsubscribe link to every email. This is required by law (PDPA in Thailand, GDPR in Europe).

7. Automation (n8n)

7.1 Available Workflows

The site includes 4 pre-built n8n automation workflows:

Workflow	Trigger	What It Does
Event Published	Webhook	Sends newsletter + prepares social copy
Weekly Reminder	Monday 9:00 AM	Sends weekly event digest to WhatsApp + email
Broken Link Monitor	Sunday 3:00 AM	Checks all URLs, emails alert if any are broken
Social Copy Generator	Webhook	Uses AI to generate Facebook/Instagram/WhatsApp/LINE copy

7.2 Setting Up n8n

1. Install n8n (self-hosted or n8n.cloud)
2. Import workflow JSON files from `/automation/n8n/`
3. Configure credentials (Brevo API key, OpenAI key, etc.)
4. Activate the workflows

7.3 Monitoring

- Check n8n's **Execution History** weekly for failed runs
 - Review the broken link report if you receive an alert email
 - Test the event published webhook after deploying changes
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8. SEO Management

8.1 What's Automatic

The site handles these SEO aspects automatically:

- **Schema.org** structured data on every page
- **Open Graph** tags for social sharing
- **Sitemap** at `/sitemap.xml` (auto-generated)
- **Robots.txt** at `/robots.txt`
- **Canonical URLs**
- **Breadcrumb** structured data

8.2 What You Control

When creating content, optimize these fields:

Field	SEO Impact	Tips
Title	High	Include keywords: "Meditation Workshop Bangkok"
Summary/Excerpt	High	This appears in Google search results
Body headings	Medium	Use <code>##</code> and <code>###</code> for structure
Alt text	Medium	Describe images for search engines
Tags	Low	Helps internal categorization

8.3 Google Search Console

1. Visit search.google.com/search-console

2. Add property for `shambhala-bangkok.org`
 3. Submit sitemap: `https://shambhala-bangkok.org/sitemap.xml`
 4. Monitor for crawl errors weekly
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9. Site Monitoring

9.1 Regular Checks

Weekly:

- ☐ Check site loads correctly
- ☐ Review Plausible analytics at plausible.io
- ☐ Update event statuses (mark past events)

Monthly:

- ☐ Check Google Search Console for errors
- ☐ Review newsletter subscriber count in Brevo
- ☐ Run Lighthouse audit (Chrome DevTools → Lighthouse tab)

Quarterly:

- ☐ Review and rotate API keys
- ☐ Update dependencies (coordinate with developer)
- ☐ Full QA pass (see QA Checklist in repository)

9.2 Vercel Dashboard

Your hosting dashboard at vercel.com shows:

- **Deployments** — build history and status
 - **Analytics** — Web Vitals performance data
 - **Logs** — API route execution logs
 - **Domains** — custom domain configuration
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10. Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
Changes don't appear after publishing	Wait 1-2 min for rebuild. Check Vercel dashboard for build errors.
CMS login fails	Clear browser cache. Try incognito mode. Verify GitHub access.
Images don't load	Check file size (< 5MB). Verify the image URL is correct.
Event not on homepage	Verify status is <code>upcoming</code> and date is in the future.
Newsletter signup fails	Check Brevo API key in Vercel env vars. Check API logs.
404 errors for old URLs	Add a redirect in <code>next.config.js</code> (developer task).
Site down	Check status.vercel.com . Rollback in Vercel if recent deploy broke it.
Slow page load	Run Lighthouse audit. Check for large images. Contact developer.

11. Security Reminders

- **Never share** CMS credentials publicly
 - **Never commit** API keys to the repository
 - **Review** editor access quarterly — remove departed members
 - **Rotate** API keys (Brevo, n8n) every 3-6 months
 - **Report** any suspicious activity to the site administrator immediately
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12. Getting Help

Type of Help	Contact
Content questions	Community coordinator
Technical issues	Site developer
CMS access	Site administrator
Brevo / newsletters	Site administrator
n8n automations	Site developer

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